



Shukla, *Principal Secretary, Tourism, Gujarat;* **Sanjeev Ahuja**, *Secretary, Tourism/IT, Goa;* **Raj Chengappa**, *Group Ediitorial Director (Publishing), India Today,* **Sahay Thakur**, *Director & Commissioner, Himachal Pradesh Tourism;* **Nand Kishor**, *Managing Director, Bihar State Tourism Development Corporation;* **Gayatri Rathore**, *Principal Secretary, Tourism, Rajasthan; and* **Vinai Kumar Saxena**, *Lieutenant Governor, Delhi*

A TRAVEL HUB



"Travellers should be a little adventurous and curious. It's not only about the destination. It's also about the people and the culture of the places"

Kiren Rijiju, Union Minister of Earth Sciences



"Venues like Bharat Mandapam and Yashobhoomi are booked for a year. With Delhi hosting several key events and exhibitions, tourism will get a huge boost"

Vinai Kumar Saxena, Lieutenant Governor of Delhi

The event also saw destinations from across India making it to the list of winners of the INDIA TODAY Tourism Survey and Awards 2023, which featured both known hotspots and hidden gems in eight states. Gujarat won four awards in different categories, while Karnataka and Bihar won in three categories each. Tourist attractions in Himachal Pradesh, Rajasthan, Goa, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra and Tamil Nadu bagged the other awards. Rijiju gave away the awards for the best tourism destinations, while Saxena conferred the awards for best-emerging destinations.

The awards were decided based on responses from frequent travellers and tourists on 121 tourist destinations nominated by state tourism boards/ministries under nine categories decided by INDIA TODAY. The survey was conducted by marketing research agency MDRA. ■

-With inputs from Avishek Ghosh Dastidar